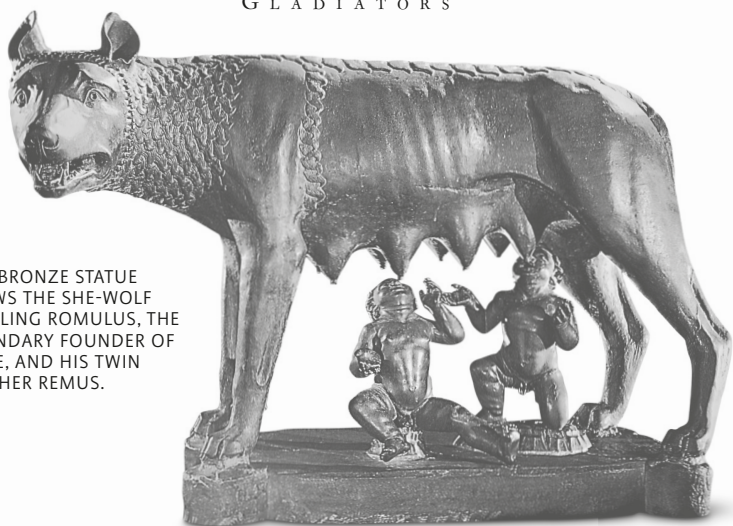


THIS BRONZE STATUE SHOWS THE SHE-WOLF SUCKLING ROMULUS, THE LEGENDARY FOUNDER OF ROME, AND HIS TWIN BROTHER REMUS.



all brothers, they argued—they couldn't decide which of them should be the king or what the city should be called. They fought, and in the struggle, Romulus killed Remus. It was left to Romulus to build the city alone, which he named Rome, after himself.

Ancient Romans believed that their city had been founded in 753 BCE, and used this year as

the first date in the Roman calendar. In fact, archaeologists have shown that Rome is much older than the Romans believed.

The truth about Rome

The real story of Rome begins 3,000 years ago, some time around 1000 BCE. This was when settlers arrived in a region that ran along the west coast of central Italy. The settlers were farmers, and they recognized that the region's fertile soil would be good for growing their crops and for raising farm animals. They built their villages on the summits of a group of seven low-lying hills near a



THIS COIN DEPICTS ROMA, THE PATRON GODDESS OF ROME. CITIZENS OF ROME WORSHIPPED HER AND ASKED HER TO PROTECT THEIR CITY.